

Digital literacy

Getting the most out of digital technology is becoming increasingly important in the modern world. Digitally literate people are those who are able to participate fully in the world of digital technology.

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Using computers

A huge part of digital literacy is what used to be called computer literacy in the pre-internet age. This is basically the ability to understand and use a computer as a tool to get things done. As more and more computers have connected to the internet, the term “digital literacy” has become more common.

IN DEPTH

Why it's important

Being computer-literate is about being able to use computers. Digital literacy is about having the tools to make the most out of the internet. Digitally literate people are able to find reliable and accurate information online, and are responsible in their use of that information.



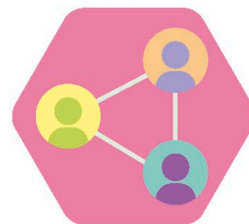
△ Finding

The first part of computer literacy is using computers to search for and navigate towards information. The information may be stored on the computer, or online.



△ Using

There is a lot of information out there, and not all of it is relevant, accurate, or up-to-date. Being able to think critically and to analyse information is a huge part of modern computer skills.



△ Sharing

Having found and evaluated information, the next step is being able to create and communicate your own thoughts to the body of information – sharing an opinion on social media, or writing a school report.



Different platforms

In the digital world, the hardware you use both requires different skills and also changes the type of thing you can do and experience. People who are digitally literate may not think twice about switching from a laptop to a touchscreen, or Windows to macOS machine, but these things might be a problem for some. Developers and designers should create software and hardware with simplicity in mind, and offer friendly support to people who want to learn to use their products.

◁ Mouse trap

People who have always used a mouse may find it difficult to navigate tablet computers by using the touchscreen hardware. Similarly, people who find touchscreens to be second nature may find it difficult to use a physical keyboard and a mouse.